

## Ford's revolution

American inventor **Henry Ford** wanted to make cars cheap and easy to run, and earn lots of money in the process. He invented the first **CONVEYOR BELT-BASED** assembly line in 1913 at his car-manufacturing plant in Michigan, where his most famous car, the Model T, could be put together in just over 90 minutes.

During the 20th century, other manufacturers copied Ford, and cars **sold by the millions**.

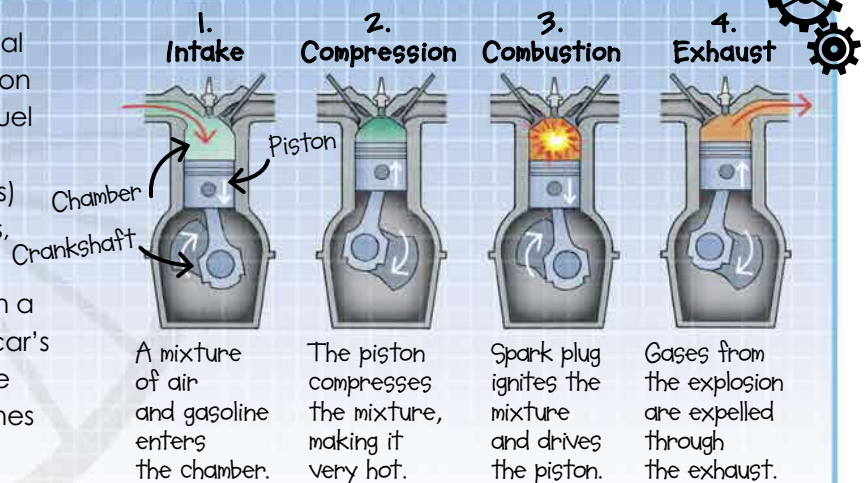


## How it changed the world

Cars allowed individuals to travel wherever they wanted, and became the world's most popular transportation. As a result, cities became bigger since people could live farther from work, though pollution from car exhaust fumes has meant that the environment has suffered.

### HOW IT WORKS

In an internal combustion engine, fuel burns (combusts) inside tubes called cylinders, producing hot gases that push pistons. The pistons turn a crankshaft that makes the car's wheels move in a four-stroke cycle. The fuel in most engines these days is gasoline.



**CAR SEAT BELTS** have been keeping drivers and passengers safe since the early 20th century.

**ROAD MARKERS** that reflect car headlights, known as "CAT'S EYES," were invented in 1933 by Percy Shaw.

